Lenino's

JACK RABBITS

Hop on—board a game of cards.
Wander lands of wooden shards.

Video tutorial
& translations

GREETINGS

Hear ye, glorious messengers,

An auspicious quest is in order: the Order of Messenger Rabbits of the Citadel hereby orders a race to procure royals for the ordinance of a Council of Thirds—the highest order ever issued to a rabbit of this Order.

***Visit the noble houses, acquire the cards of three royals, and bring them to the citadel**, in that order.*

Note that I wrote "that order" not in reference to any other order of messenger rabbits, nor the order that drives this letter, but the order of the steps you must take in order to fully restore the realm's order.

So, hoppity hop, in orderly fashion. Our rabbits don't evade rules.

The White Herald

OVERVIEW

Visit houses turn by turn,
bringing numbered cards in hand.
Claim their royals and return,
holding three to rule the land.

To fulfill THE ACQUISITION,
add ten points that match their suit.
With THE LOTTERY's provision,
you'll be drawing cards as loot.

Make THE JOURNEY hex to hex—
every road is free to course.
Pay THE TRANSFERS for the treks:
hikes off-road, by boat or horse.

Rest upon a hex-shaped tile,
if you don't end up OFF-BOARD.
Draw the card atop the pile—
that's THE INCREMENT reward.

OBJECTIVE

Reach this place where you begin,
with three royal cards in hand.
You must be the first to win,
hailed as champion of the land.

But before the quest may start,
choose a challenge for the mission.
Set its circle as a mark,
for the trio's win condition:

- ○ SIMPLE: any royal cards.
- Or DIVERSE: three different suits.
- Or MONARCHIC: King, Queen, Jack.
- Or DIVERSE-MONARCHIC too.
- Or the TRIBAL, which is hard: royals of one suit pursuit.

SETUP

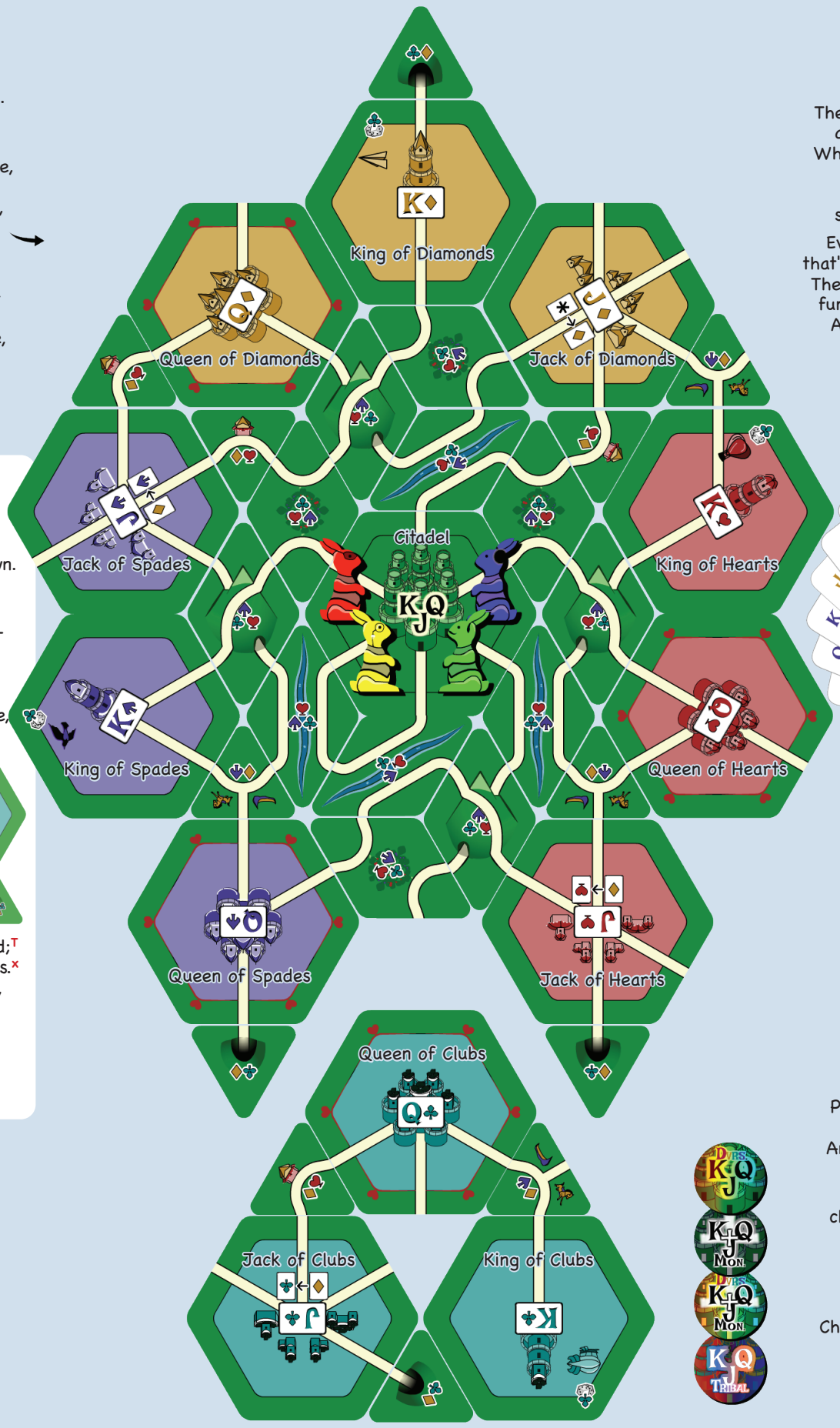
Up to four players

1 SET THE BOARD

At the start of every match,
you must first complete a board.
Map it randomly from scratch,
or revisit one explored.

Link the houses from each throne,
which are hexes in this spread.
BUILD THE LANDSCAPE on your own,
or the sample right ahead.

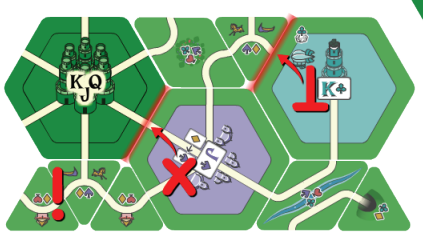
If there're children under nine,
only play to build the land.
Let them wander their design—
with a rabbit in their hand.
Bring the cards in down the line,
and the rules they understand.



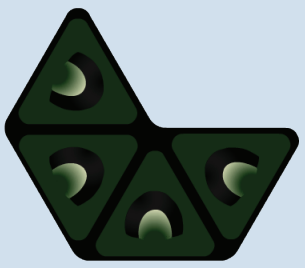
BUILD THE LANDSCAPE

Place the *Citadel* tile first.
Leave aside the *underground*.
Group and shuffle all the rest:
twelve of all three shapes facedown.
Deal by shape to every guest,
each will get the same amount.

Take your turns to place a tile—
pick a tile to flip and place.
Or set out in loose freestyle—
flip all tiles to see their face.
These suggestions are worthwhile,
loosely meant in either case:



Don't make dead-ends on the road;[T]
don't connect roads from two hexes.[×]
Place triangles scattered broad,
not the ones alike connected.[!]
Hexes may be placed abroad,
starting islands disconnected.
But the underground is odd—
only rabbit holes connect it.



Underground

2 SET THE CARDS

Lay the *court* in any order,
after placing every tile.
These are *royal* cards and *jokers*,
and will form a faceup aisle.
What remains are *pips* in number,
and the *aces* of each style.
Give a shuffle as in poker—
set a facedown drawing *pile*.

Every player gets three cards,
that's their *hand* to start the chase.
These resources, each one guards,
fund THE JOURNEY they will face.
And pay royals their regards,
per THE ACQUISITION phase.

3 SET THE TOKENS

Players choose their token rabbits,
set them on the *Citadel*.
And collect their matching carrots—
they get three of these as well.

For OBJECTIVE of the game,
choose the kind of quest you're on.
If a circle marks this aim,
set it on the hexagon.

Now select the starting player,
and the order of the turns.
Choose your ways for this endeavor—
none of these are my concerns.

This concludes the setup frame.
Now complete the INTRO GAME.

SETUP must precede this frame, which explains the **INTRO GAME**. Learn each phase's role and name—then attempt the **STANDARD GAME**.

FOUR PHASES OF A TURN

1ST THE LOTTERY

Start your turns by rolling dice,
so that two results unfold.
You may draw a one-card prize—
if you show a card you hold.
Prove it matches value-wise,
either number you just rolled.

Please discard if caught with ten.
Bring your hand to nine again.*

Hold the outcome of the dice.
Transfers use it as **THE PRICE**.

2ND THE JOURNEY

You may choose a path to exit,
from the current hex you're on.
Move along the road selected,
let your rabbit venture on.
Cross small tiles but stop at hexes—
reach the nearest hexagon.

Move on closer to your goal.
Or perhaps don't move at all.

You may switch your travel mode.
See **THE TRANSFERS** off the road.

3RD THE ACQUISITION

It's your goal to claim the card—
claim the royal you salute.
You must visit and discard:
ten or more in that card's suit.
Place a carrot as your mark,
and remove it from pursuit.

You may always be a guest.
Make no claim and stop to rest.

Keep the royals in your hands.
Get **THE INCREMENT** at once.

4TH THE INCREMENT

End your turns on a hex tile—
if you don't fall off shore.**
Draw the card atop the pile,
and your turn will be no more.
You may need to first repile:
shuffle what was spent before.

*Hands should not exceed nine cards.
Anyone who's caught discards.

**Off the board there's no reward.
See the rules about **OFF-BOARD**.

THE PRICE

For the transfers on the way,
pay the total on the dice.
But in case you overpay,
then consider that the price.
Use as many cards to pay,
check each symbol qualifies.
Royals' value never sway—
note their price remains precise.

Set aside the cards you spend—
they're *discarded* once you're done.
Royals may be spent as **10**,
and the **Aces** are worth **1**.
When a royal card is spent,
put it back where it begun.
And remove your carrot then,
since your claim has been undone.

THE TRANSFERS

If you venture on the paths,
you'll move freely on your round.
This includes the underpass,
found in mountains farther down.
Other moves demand **THE PRICE**,
paid in suits upon the ground.
Pay the total on your dice—
that's the minimum amount.

TRAILWAYS

At the mountains, rivers, woods,
two roads lie not far apart.
You may hike between these two,
cutting through the middle part.
Pay with cards of proper suits:
club or spade or even heart.

MERCHANTS

Stationed where the road is forked,
there's a horse and boat to ride.
Reach a place across the board,
over tiles at gallop stride.
Or select a road to port,
gliding on the seas outside.
Landlocked merchants have no boats,
since their post is not seaside.
Merchants send you from their post,
once you pay what dice decide.

JOKERS

When you pay a tavern's host,
keep a ride you set aside.
Choose a joker card to hold,
and release to claim their ride.

RABBIT HOLES

Pay to travel cave to cave,
use this trick to hop around.
But if you prefer to save,
pay a visit *underground*.
Take this turn to wait and waive—
hop on out the coming round.

OFF-BOARD

If you venture off the board,
on a road that leads outbound,
end your **JOURNEY** overboard,
where no **INCREMENT** is found.
Next your **LOTTERY**'s off-board,
and you'll **JOURNEY** underground!
There your **INCREMENT**'s restored,
and you'll wait another round.

There are four sets of **ROAD TILES**.

Now the challenge is afoot—add these strategies per suit. Yet this **STANDARD GAME**'s pursued once the **INTRO**'s understood.

CLOVERS (Clubs)

FLY FROM KING TOWERS

Show one card before you roll,
cast **THE JOURNEY** to the skies.
Pick a tower as a goal,
if it beats the dice or ties.
Or you'll miss the board and fall—
play **THE LOTTERY** likewise.
Dropped off-board or standing tall,
tumblers keep the card that tries.

Land your flight and don't fall off,
if you pay to reach the dice.
Count how far your card was off:
pay this shortfall to suffice.
Note the hex where you took off,
just the suit from there applies.
You may trade the shown card off—
where the clubs fulfill the price.

SPADES (Swords)

FIGHT FOR CARDS

You may steal a card at random,
kicking someone off the board.
You must meet to seize their item,
use your spades to wield a sword.
Both go back and forth in tandem,
adding spades to beat what's scored.
When no cards are thrown to sum them,
then the struggler's kicked off-board.

Note that tying scores is barred,
and discard the spades outpoured.
If your target wins the war,
they can't steal a card you hoard.
If you steal a royal card,
set **THE ACQUISITION** forth:
place your carrot as the mark—
give one up if it's your fourth.

HEARTS (Cups)

VET QUEEN PALACES

Any player may contest,
as you reach a queen's own throne:
"Show six points to prove you're blest,
adding hearts from cards you own."
Or proceed like honored guest,
if your carrot marks this zone.
Those off-board cannot protest—
they're not fit to cast a stone.

Yet before they check your cards,
they're obliged to show their own.
Even standing far apart:
let the proof they're blest be known.
If you prove at least six hearts,
they'll discard the hearts they've shown.
Either one proved wrong departs—
off the board the meddler's thrown.

DIAMONDS (Gold)

TRADE AT JACK PLAZAS

All spent cards are being sold,
every Jack will sell its suit.
Browse the lot their houses hold,
where you may obtain this loot.
Match or overpay with gold,
see the markings underfoot.
Note the asterisk in bold—
any suit at all will suit.

If agreed when setup starts,
you may add the **DIAMONDS BOOST**+:
player trades with diamond cards,
on their turn where both set foot.
Never show your hand's rewards—
strike a deal beyond dispute.
If what's traded proves a farce,
swindlers get the off-board boot.

If your turn falls off the board, skip **THE INCREMENT** this round. When your turn begins off-board, end **THE JOURNEY** underground.

+ Try these **OPTIONAL ADDITIONS**. They'll refresh your future missions.

+ AMBIVALENT ACES

Choose to use them as **11**,
any time you play an **Ace**.
Or a **1** when it's deserving—
lottery or marketplace.

+ CAPITAL ACES

Your first **Ace** is worth **11**,
and the rest you'll use are **1**s.
As a record that it's spent then,
keep it laid before your hands.

+ ADDITIONAL CAPITAL

When you play **CAPITAL ACES**,
add a stable bonus tip.
At the suit-appropriate places,
they will grant an extra pip.

+ ADVANCED CITADEL

There are three depicted assets,
on this flip-side tile reboot:
vet the hearts to grant the access;
buy with diamonds any loot;
show your clubs for flying passes—
shortfall's paid in any suit.

+ TIGHT SUITS

Have as many suits as players,
and a set of road tiles too.
Say there's only three contenders,
then remove a set and suit.
Pick a fitting kind of ending:
one that cards allow you to.
Even if it's unintended
playing tight gives **SPADES** a **BOOST**.

+ CLOVERS BOOST

When you fly from any tower,
find more places to touch down.
Clubs expand their landing power—
any hex above the ground.

+ HEARTS BOOST

If a guest comes where you stand—
anywhere but underground—
or your carrot marks that land,
vet their hearts to turn them down.

+ TRAILING CARROTS

Once your carrot's been in place,
you won't need to wait around.
Royals claimed provide a trace—
you may leave in the same round.

+ WINDFALL LOTTERY

Claim your prizes as a batch,
give the lottery no limits.
Honor all the cards that match,
and when matching double digits.

+ OVERTAXED HANDS

Trim the cards you hold on to.
Up to six you may accrue.

+ SEIZED SURPLUS

Don't get caught with cards abound.
Your revealer robs you down.

+ PATRIARCHAL VALUES

Have unequal value levels:
Ace then **King** then **Queen** then **Jack**—
from **14** until **11**—
contemplate why this is whack.

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